Exquisite craft works from north, south eastern India

Finely carved wooden furniture, Madhubani and pattachitra paintings, leather bags and chappals, textiles and dress materials, block printed sarees, glass jewellery and bead works and terracotta items from many handicraft centres mainly of north India are tastefully displayed in Rajaji Hall on Mount Road. Nearly 20 craft associations all over north and south eastern parts of India, are represented in this show.

Wooden chairs, stools tripods, shelves, carved wooden frames, paper weights, lamp stands and side tables (from Delhi-Bhulebisare Kalakar Society) make out of teak and sandal wood, occupy a large corner.

The colourful durries bedsheets, woollen and cloth bed covers (from Javaja Weavers Assn., Rajasthan) are highly attractive.

Craftsmanship of great skill and aesthetic awareness is seen in the many "Mithila paintings", depicting the epic and puranic themes. We have narration of common themes in some panels depicting the men and women engaged in their daily toil. A striking picture of "Durga" and an episode from Mahabaratha "Drowpadi Vastraparana" are neatly executed with a delicate pen and brush. These paintings are from Dharbhanga in Bihar.

Pattachitra paintings, and drawings on tasser silk, decorated wooden toys and Lord Jagannath, Balabadra and Subadra, are fine decorative carvings. The applique articles (from Pippli in Orissa) are rich and colourful. They include table covers weall hangings, napkins and huge garden umbrellas.

Since the craftsmen have lost their traditional market and position in the community "Dastkar", a Delhi based society for crafts provides exposure to producer groups and craft skills through periodic exhibitions, publicity and provision of outlets for marketing their goods. The Crafts Council of India which is doing great service for the survival and promotion of traditional handicrafts, has organised this exhibition, with the cooperation of "Dastkar" to enable the craftsmen to meet consumers directly. The show will be on view till September 8, daily from 10 a.m. to 7 p.m.—**NRB.**

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